Aryasomayajula Ram Bharadwaj

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RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

LASR Labs @ Arcadia Impact **Jan 2026 – Present**

London AI Safety Research Labs, with the UK AI Security Institute, London, UK

AI Safety Researcher (funded extension) Jul 2026 – Present

First author of *Tracing Eval-Awareness Emergence Through Training of OLMo 3* – Alignment Forum, 2026.

- Used stepwise model-checkpoints to attribute the emergence of evaluation awareness to specific training stages in OLMo-3 models.
- Awarded a 30,000-hour compute grant on the Isambard supercomputer (Bristol Centre for Supercomputing) to study how grader awareness emerges during training.

Research Fellow Jan 2026 – Apr 2026

Co-first author of *EvalDetectBench* – NeurIPS 2026 Evaluations & Datasets Track (Poster), arXiv:2609.01611.

- Co-designed an open, Inspect-compatible pipeline for measuring evaluation awareness in frontier LLMs.
- Identified a novel generator-identity confound in evaluation-awareness measurement: the model generating deployment transcripts systematically biases judge scores – an effect prior work did not isolate, and one large enough to reorder model rankings.
- Proposed a covariate-adjusted AUROC that corrects for the confound, restoring measurement validity with minimal error.
- Helped secure $125,000 in follow-on funding to extend our research on evaluation awareness.

ENGINEERING EXPERIENCE

Associate Technical Architect **Nov 2024 – Dec 2025**

Quantiphi Analytics, Bengaluru

- Designed AI agent system for automated issue severity classification and escalation management.
- Architected conversational AI-agent chatbot for a major telecom company's sales team, refactoring legacy systems to LangGraph and reducing codebase size significantly.
- Revamped RAG data ingestion pipeline, improving retrieval accuracy by 20% and reducing time to first token by 3x.

Senior Developer - Innovation & Development Labs **June 2019 – Nov 2024**

Mu Sigma Business Solutions, Bengaluru

- Led a team building a semi-autonomous data analysis platform using AutoGen, with automated prompt optimization and locally hosted LLMs.
- Built and maintained a high-velocity trading platform: migrated deployment to Kubernetes, rewrote trade-signal generation from R to Scala (Akka), enabling near real-time portfolio visualization.
- Developed ML model operationalization platform with automatic retraining pipelines and canary/blue-green deployment strategies.
- Received 6 Star Performer awards and 2 Impact Awards for technical leadership and delivery excellence.

FELLOWSHIPS & RESIDENCIES

AI Resident - Lossfunk AI Residency **May 2025 – June 2025**

- Selected (5% acceptance, 10 researchers) for an in-person residency focused on independent technical research in interpretability.
- Built **PID-Steering**: extended activation steering by treating the steering coefficient as a controlled variable updated each token via PID feedback on an observed behavioural signal, addressing the brittleness of open-loop steering vectors.

RESEARCH & PUBLICATIONS

Tracing Evaluation-Awareness Emergence Through Training of OLMo-3

Aryasomayajula R. Bharadwaj, *R. Kirk* **Alignment Forum, 2026**

- Analyzed the emergence of evaluation awareness across OLMo-3 training checkpoints, studying how awareness develops during training rather than only in fully trained models.
- Investigated measurement methodology and behavioral indicators relevant to evaluation-awareness research and frontier-model evaluations.

EvalDetectBench: A Benchmark for Measuring Evaluation Awareness in Frontier Language Models

*X. Li**, *K. Ochwang'i**, ***Aryasomayajula R. Bharadwaj****, *A. Souly, R. Kirk*

*Equal contribution (co-first authors) **NeurIPS 2026 ED Track (Poster)**

- Open, Inspect-compatible benchmark for evaluation-awareness measurement. Identifies two methodological choices in prior work – probe-question transfer across model families and transcript-generator identity – that introduce systematic bias and can reorder model rankings; proposes per-model probe calibration and a stratified generator-harmonisation correction.

Understanding Hidden Computations in Chain-of-Thought Reasoning

Sole author **arXiv:2412.04537, Dec 2024**

- Investigated whether transformer models trained with filler-token CoT perform genuinely hidden serial computation, or whether the discarded reasoning trace remains recoverable from internal activations – directly relevant to faithful-CoT and unfaithful chain-of-thought debates.
- Used layer-wise logit-lens analysis and token-rank inspection to decode the original non-filler characters from intermediate residual-stream representations without loss of downstream performance, showing the computation is encoded in the activations rather than inaccessible.

AWARDS & RECOGNITIONS

Honorable Mention - AI Alignment Awards **July 2023**

AI Safety Research Competition

- Recognized among 118 global entries for a research proposal on "goal misgeneralization" in AI systems.

Honorable Mention - Eliciting Latent Knowledge **March 2022**

Alignment Research Center

- Recognized for innovative approach to open research problem in AI safety.

Bronze Medal - Build-on-Redis Hackathon **February 2021**

Redis Labs

- Developed text-to-code search tool using CodeBERT embeddings and Redis Stack for private repository indexing.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology – Electronics and Communications Engineering **2015–2019**

GMR Institute of Technology, Andhra Pradesh